

combos for dinner for the week: ‘Who wants meatloaf, semi-frozen Strasburg and a frost-covered Paddle Pop?’

There was nothing wrong with the fridge. It was a (thrifty) constant, a part of my childhood.

Look, teaching your kids to be cynical about the consumer culture isn’t about being a tight-arse: ‘Kids, from now on we’re going to have one “family toothbrush” which we all use. It’ll save us money *and* help the environment!’

And it’s not about being a ‘minimalist’—kids don’t understand minimalism: ‘I’m sorry, Liam, but we’re throwing out B2; you’ve already got B1—a second banana is just redundant.’

Rather, it’s about talking to your kids and letting them see you make smart, considered purchasing decisions.

Your job is to override the constant marketing they’re subjected to, with your own messages:

‘In our family, we don’t get sucked into marketing.’

‘In our family, we pride ourselves on scoring great deals because we’re savvy shoppers.’

‘In our family, we are good with money.’

Get it?

And sometimes . . . you can even have a little fun doing it.

‘Flogglebox’

Another way to break the conditioning is to play a game I call ‘Flogglebox’.

Think of it like *Gogglebox* (the TV show about people watching TV shows), but for ads.

(Fun fact: my wife was a producer on *Gogglebox*.)